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Farm Labor Measure On November 2 Ballot

CHAVEZ PLEDGES "PEOPLE'S CAMPAIGN" TO SUPPORT PROP. 14

(Oakland, Calif.) - Speaking before an enthusiastic audience of close to 1,000 at St. Elizabeth's Church here, Cesar Chavez, president of the United Farm Workers (UFW) of America, AFL-CIO, pledged to mount a statewide "people's campaign" person to person, mouth-to-mouth" to support a "Yes" vote on Proposition 14, the long fought for agricultural labor initiative on the November 2 ballot.

"The only real issue around Proposition 14," Chavez told the packed-in, multiethnic crowd, "is that with its passage, farm workers will have a right, a guaranteed right, to determine by themselves whether or not they want a union."

"And if they want a union, which union."

"That is the central issue of Proposition 14: guaranteeing the workers' rights to self-organization. Basically, it's this: do farm-workers have the right to vote? There is nothing more critical or important than that issue."

The early evening rally at St. Elizabeth's, which is located in the heart of this city's predominantly Chicano Fruitvale District, was part of a well-publicized kick-off for the "Yes on 14" campaign in Northern California.

In addition, Black Panther Party chairperson Elaine Brown was also scheduled to participate, but was unavoidably detained and arrived too late to address the audience. Following Chavez's speech, Elaine chatted briefly with the UFW leader.

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CESAR CHAVEZ, president of the United Farm Workers of America, AFL-CIO, addressed a crowd of close to 1,000 people at a high-spirited rally held in Oakland's St. Elizabeth Church to kick off the Northern California campaign for Proposition 14.

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